Billing at AT&T

A high-trust, low stress phone bill

THE CHALLENGE

At AT&T billing was the top call driver across all customer support channels. Additionally, a negative billing experience was the largest detractors from customer happiness measures.

MY CONTRIBUTIONS

I was the lead experience designer working across physical and digital touch points to deliver a friction-less, easy to understand billing experience.

OUR SOLUTION

An complete overhaul of a legacy billing system that dramatically simplified artifacts and intuitively surfaced information that customers needed to understand.

"Paying your bill early is just giving your money away.
I learned that from my dad when I was in college." -Candice

CONTEXT

After synthesizing extensive research with customers about how they thought about money, bills, billing and payments we identified 6 design principles that we could measure the success of our work against.

THIS ARTIFACT

We created several customer billing journeys and identified touch points within those journeys to demonstrate the new billing design principles. At this stage these were not complete reference documents, but a tool to communicate with other team about the direction we were taking.

NEXT STEPS

Ultimately I evolved these designs into the actual reference designs that the production engineers would use to build the next iteration of the billing interactions on the website, app and printed bills.

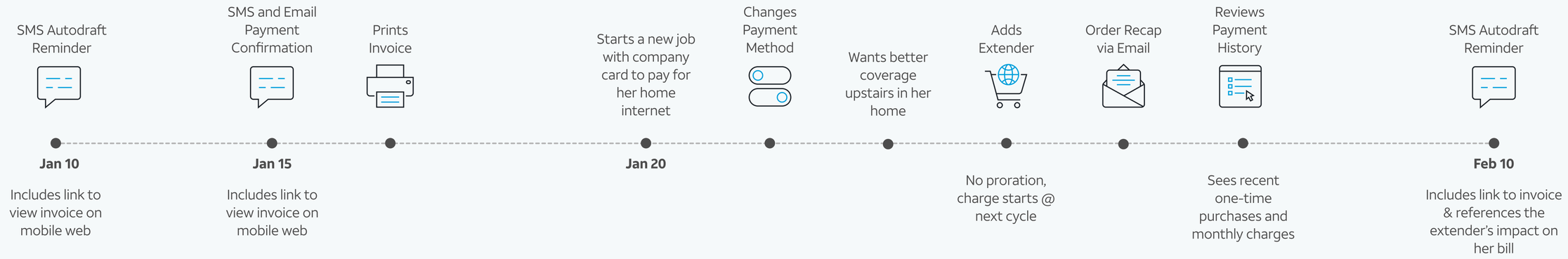
Account Management - Billing

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Kate’s MRC Change

Paperless | Autopay [Drafted 15th of each month]



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Earning Trust

Our research has shown that there is a trust deficit in billing to be overcome. The rebuild trust we are making and delivering on promises through communication cadences (SMS and/or email) that are strongly aligned to the billing artifacts across channels.

Predictable communication cadences

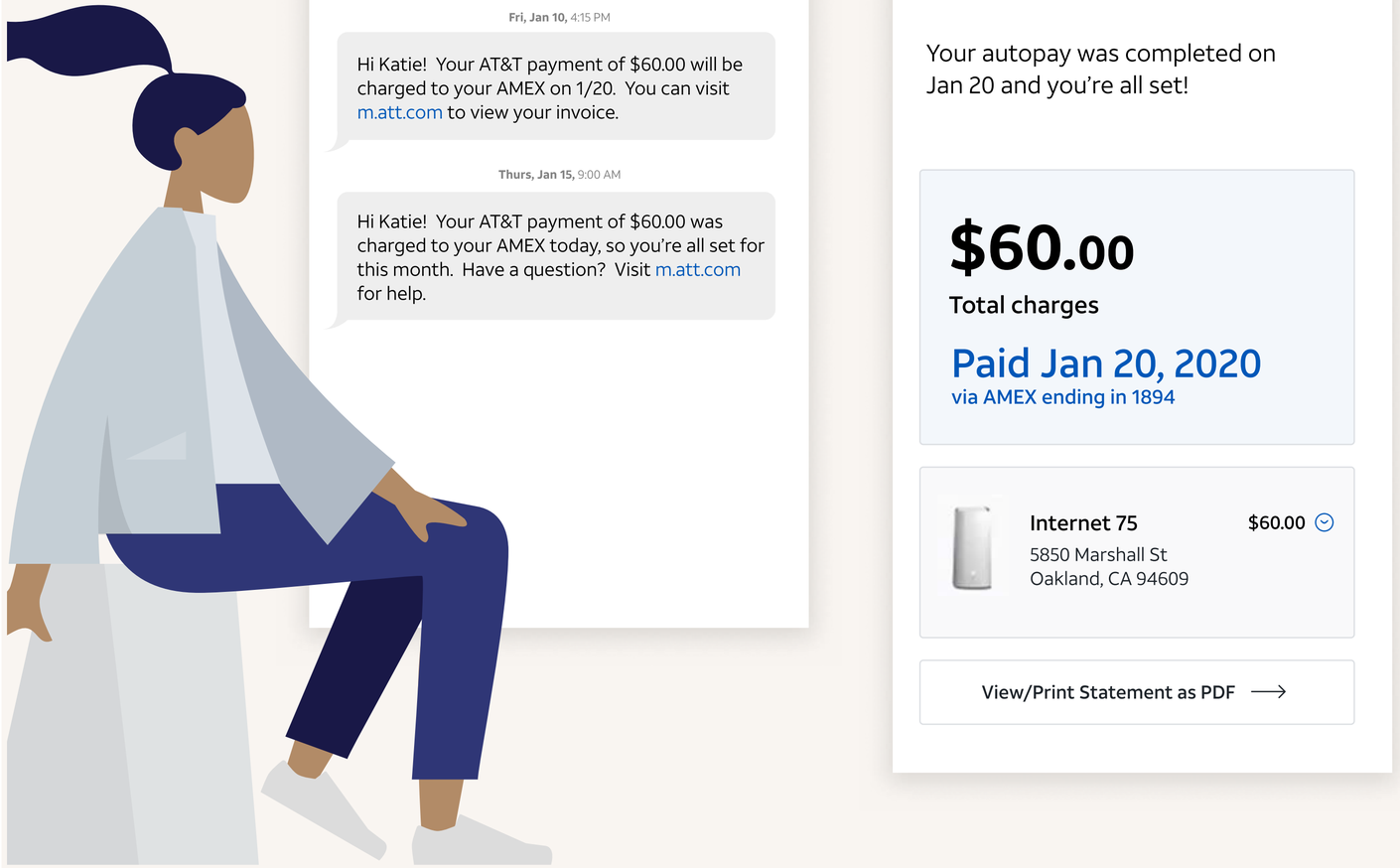
- Customized to user preference
- Highlights high consequence billing activity
- Creates confidence that we're working for them

Simplified interactions

- Focus on completed tasks
- Emphasis on most important details
- Establishes confidence to self-serve

Capabilities to explore more

- Reduces redundancy and clutter
- Balances transparency with ease of use



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Purposeful Organization

We know that phone support is the most relied-upon channel for customers when billing feels like it's gone wrong. We want to leverage what users are geting out of that interaction in our digital and print billing experiences. A step-by-step story of the account for a given prioducrs that highlights cause and effect,

Tells a story of the account history

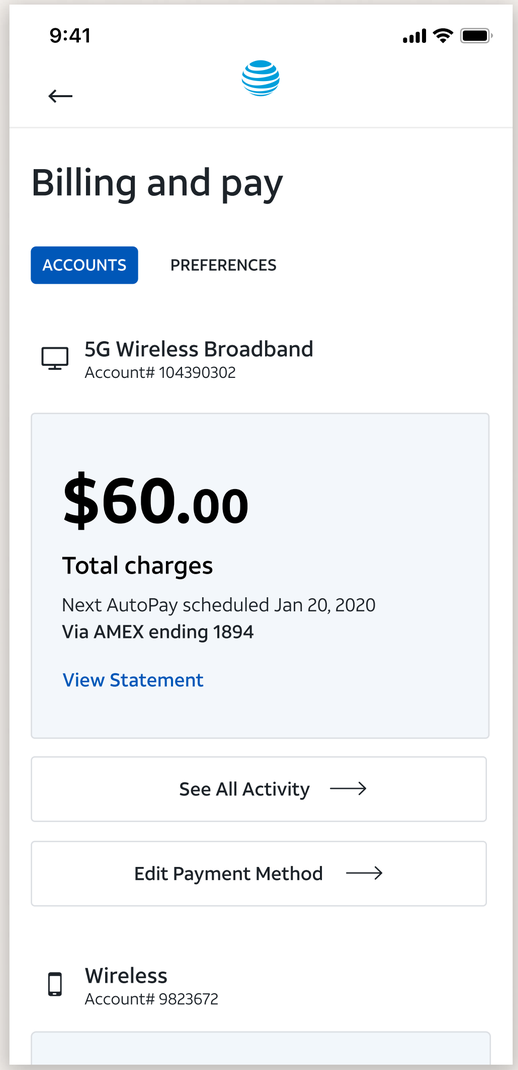
- Allows customers to understand 'what happened' without needing to call and ask for help
- Surfaces the account history details so that users don't have to view multiple screens to answer one question

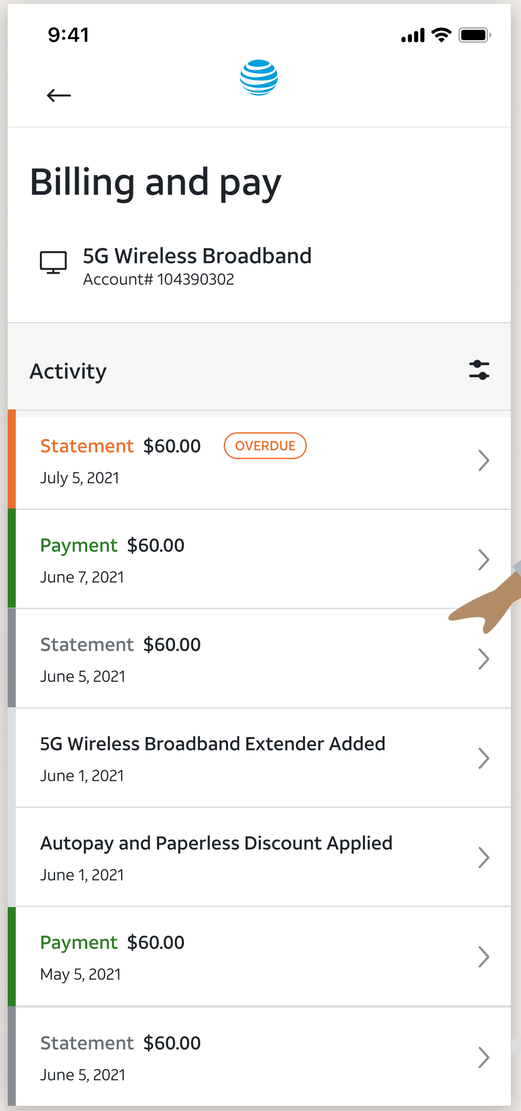
Reduces the complexity of account management flows

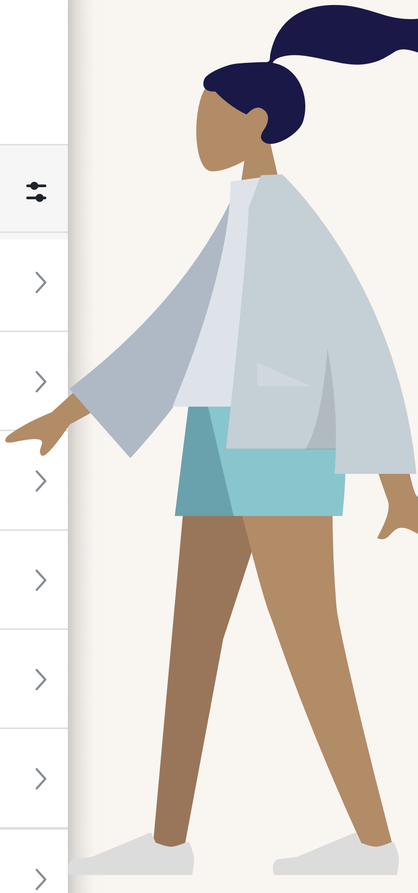
- Puts billing management options in one place
- Communicates benefits of the happy path experience

Extensible across product and user-type

- Organization that can accomodate multiple products with different preferences for each product
- Activity feed accomodates multiple users on one account
- Clusters activity by product







Prototype

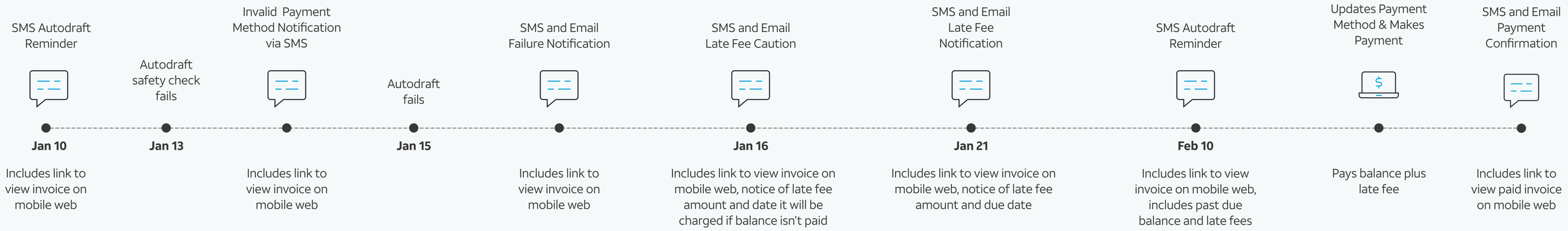
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CUSTOMER JOURNEY

Jacks' Payment Failure

Paperless | Autopay [Drafted 15th of each month]



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Adaptivity

The digital bill can adapt to the current cirucmstances of the account and show just want is relevant to that user. Instead of asking customers to do their own billing forensics investigation, we are surfacing the most-important information and allowing them to flow easily between relevant documents.

Dynamic presentation of real-time data

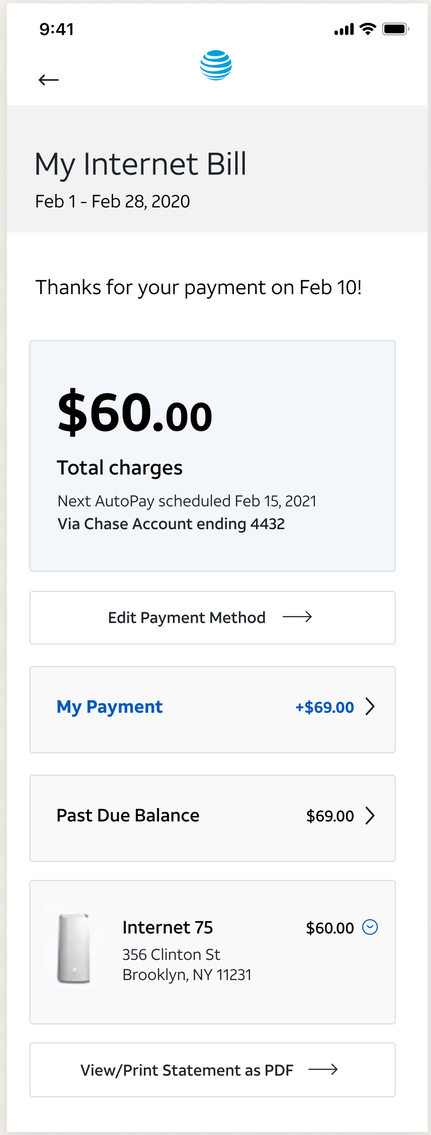
- Describe what's important and why
- Call out any key enablers
- List assumptions

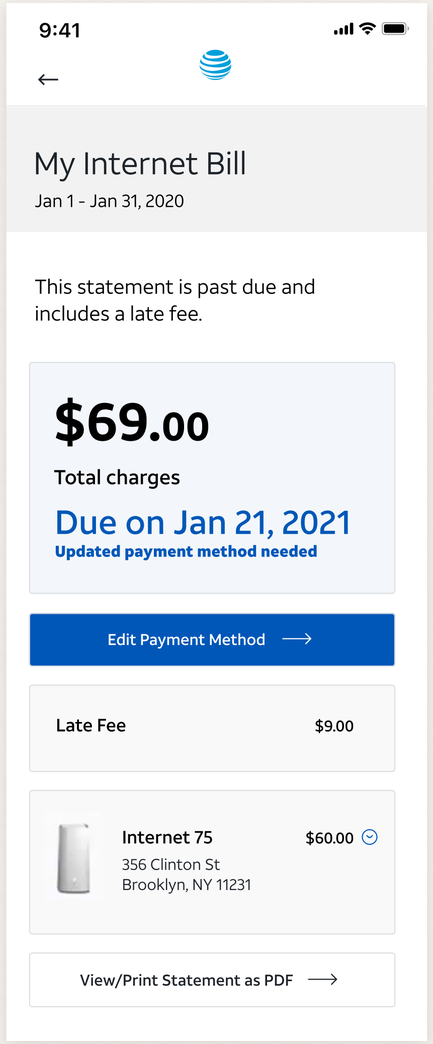
A simple interface to accomodate complex interactions

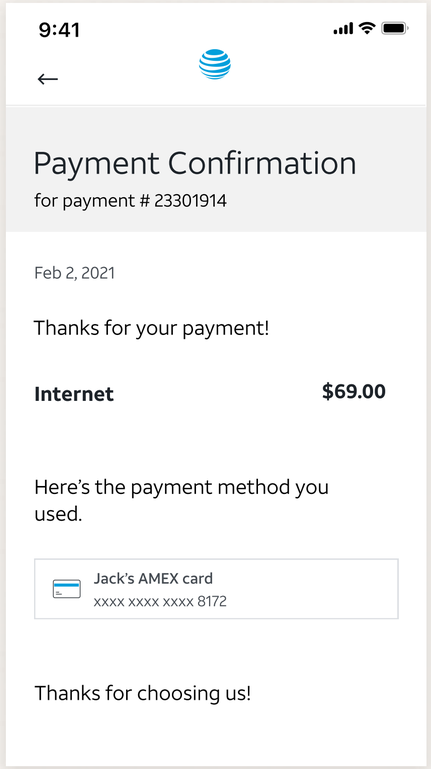
- Describe what's important and why
- Call out any key enablers
- List assumptions

Clear pathways forward

- Describe what's important and why
- Call out any key enablers
- List assumptions







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Thoughtful backstops

While we attend to the big picture, we're also paying attention to the details of where a journey can go wrong and patching experience gaps when we find them.

Catching common mistakes before they happen

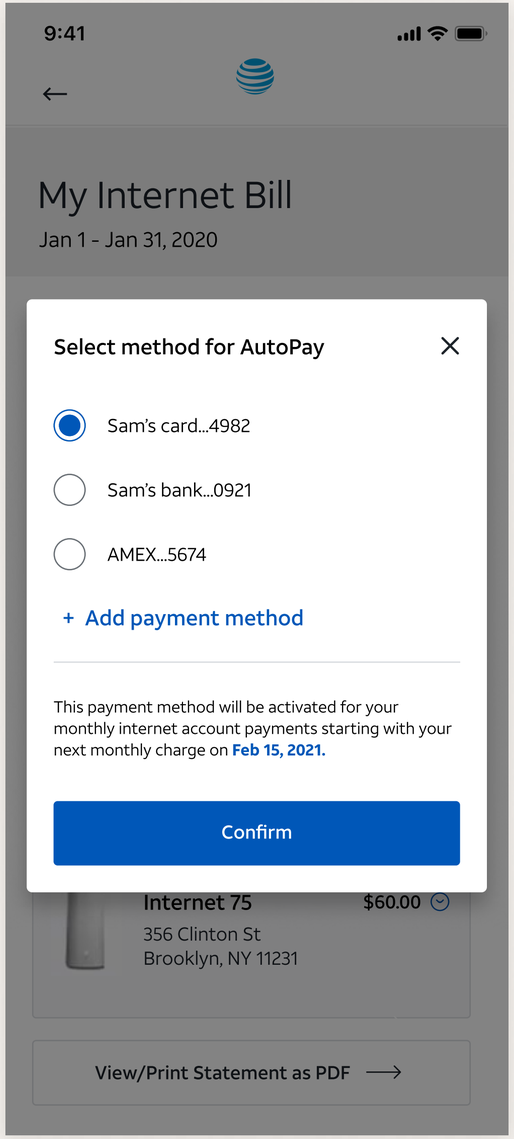
- Aligning flows to customer intention
- Addressing gaps in the existing flows
- Anticipating complex needs

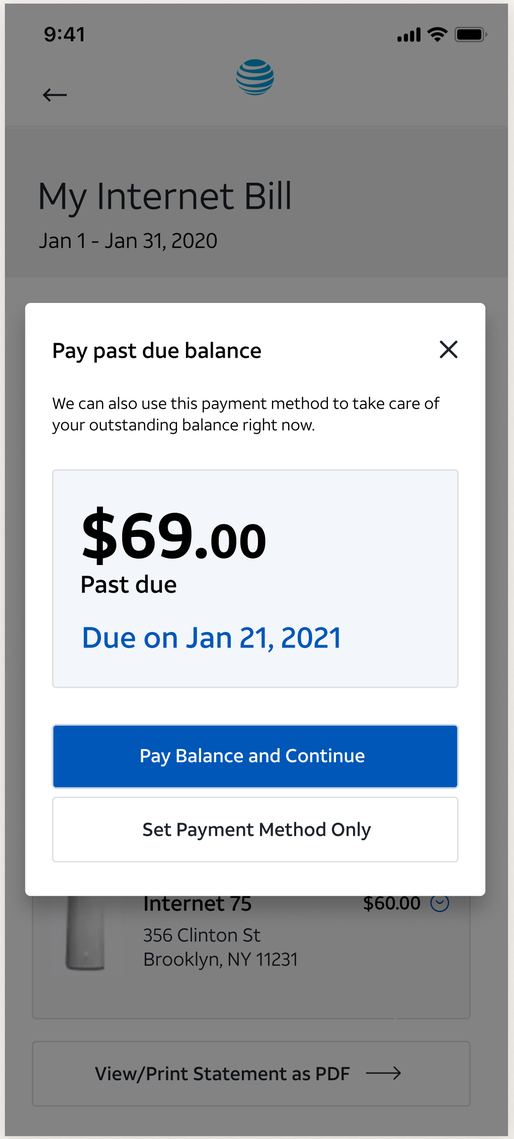
Streamlining journey

- Eliminating repetitive actions
- Consolidating multi-step processes in single flows

Accomodating mutliple approaches

- Making edge case experiences as easy as the happy path
- Understanding larger context of user actions







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Elena’s Account Management

Manual to Paperless & Autopay

SMS Due Date Reminder



Jan 10

Includes link to view invoice on mobile web

Emails Invoice to Spouse



Jan 12

Online Manual Payment



Opts into Paperless and Autopay in payment flow

SMS and Email Payment Confirmation



Includes link to view invoice on mobile web and confirms autopay enrollment

Changes Communication Preferences



Adds Spouse as Authorized Payer



Jan 27

Email Confirmation of Added Authorized Payer



Each user receives a confirmation message

Autodraft Confirmation Email



Feb 20

Includes link to view invoice on mobile web

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Reducing Friction

By emphasizing options that result in stable bills and predictable invoices, we can reduce the confusion and call-center volume that comes from anomolous customer choices.

Funnel users to the happy path

- Normalize payments that match amount due to reduce confusion and customer-generated volatility
- Highlight the ease and value of paying via AutoPay and offer one click, in-flow enrollment
- Over-deliver on our Paperless & AutoPay discount for new enrollees

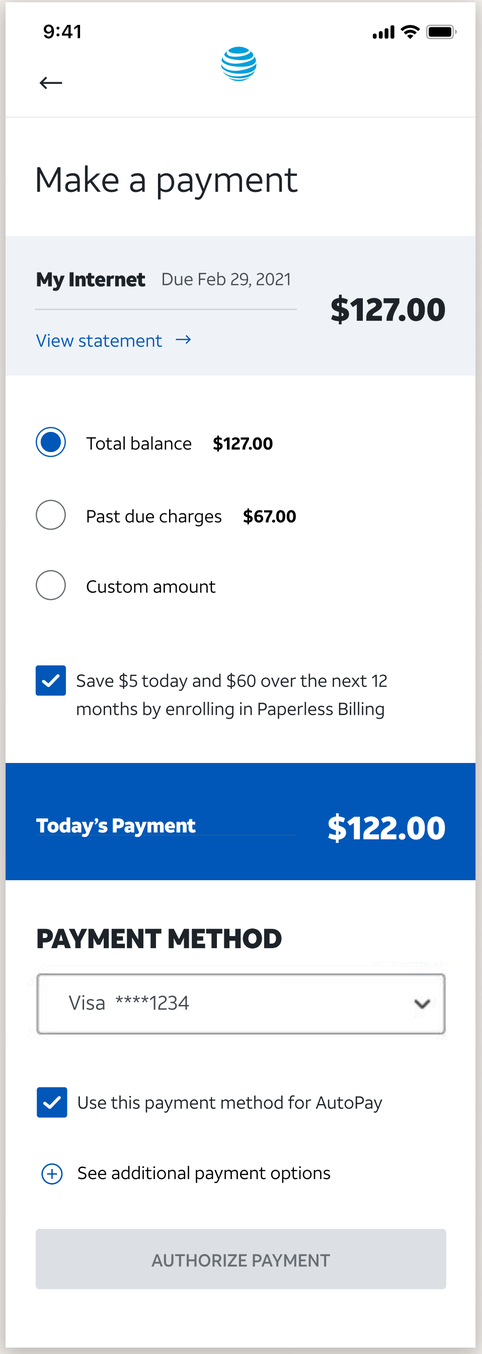
Anticipate common deviations from the happy path

- Behaviors of late payers are taken into account
- A flow that is adaptable to multiple payers/payments

Provide for unique situations

- Payment arrangements, overpayments, delayed payments and alternative payment options are available, but not emphasized
- Backstops to catch unintentional deviatons from the happy path (underpayments, scheduling past the due date, unusual overpayments, etc)





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A Holistic View

Billing and identity are the peanut butter and jelly of account management. A holistic view of the billing experience takes into account ways users are already sharing billing tasks and information and can grow to accomodate new ways of doing so.

Integrated understanding of customer expectations

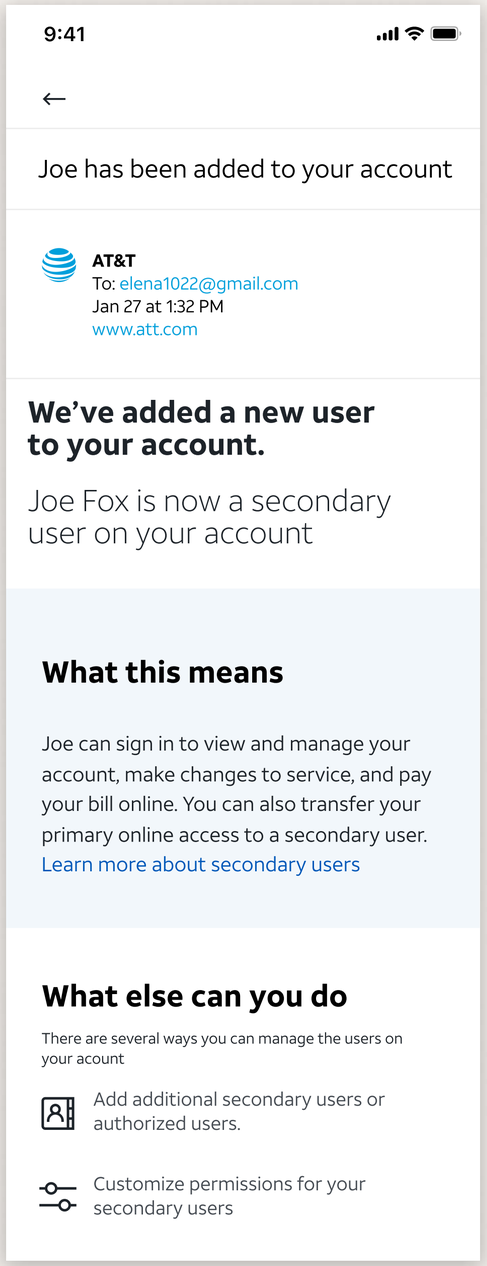
- Usability testing spanning identity and billing account management tasks tells us where users expect specific account management tools
- High level research into how users think about their account security informs identity work and billing work

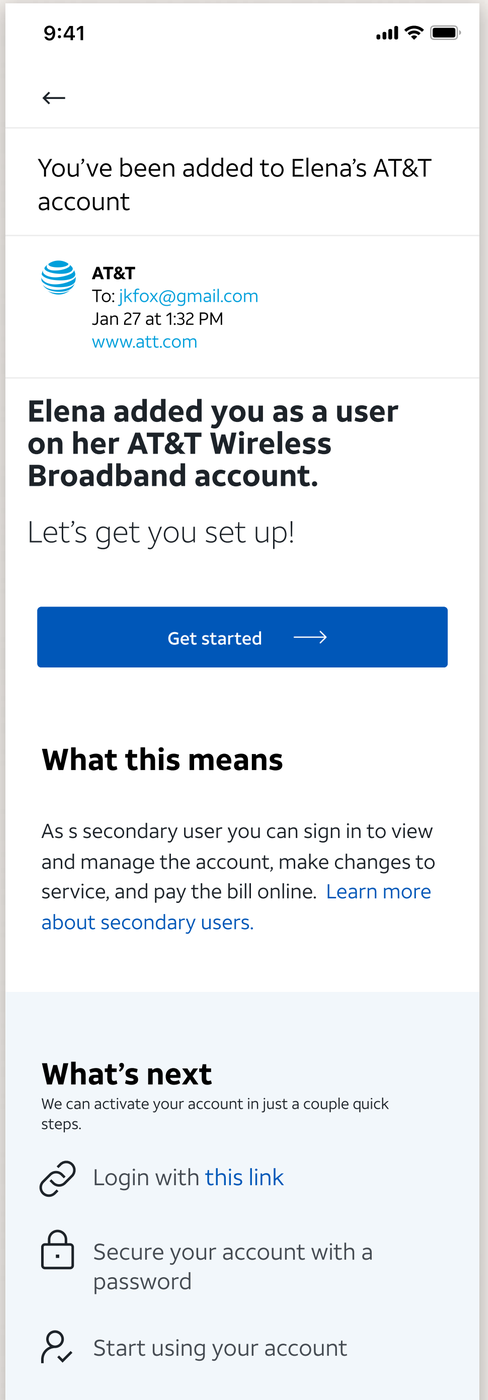
Aligning our tools to existing user behaviors

- Customers have created their own work-arounds to get the billing experience that they need
- Understanding these ‘desire paths’ helps us build the right account management tools for billing

The account holder is not our only user

- Caring for the experience of secondary users improves the experience for all users
- Account holders have a strong desire for secure ways to engage secondary users







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